

Ques. Is GATE good for CSE?

Ans. The applicants can use the GATE score for the admissions to postgraduate courses like MTech, MS, PhD offered at IITs and IISc. Candidates' GATE score will also help them to get jobs in PSUs.

Ques. Are 3 months enough for GATE preparation?

Ans. It is advised to start preparing early, preferably in the pre-final year of the undergraduate programme so that students have ample time to cover the entire GATE syllabus. However, students with a good basic understanding of all subjects covered in the GATE can crack the exam with less preparation and that too with a good score.

Ques. Which PSU is best for CSE?

Ans. The top PSUs for CSE are BARC and IOCL. Other than that Power System Operation Corporation Ltd, Punjab State Power Corporation Ltd and West Bengal State Electricity Distribution Company Limited also recruit CSE candidates.

GATE 2026 is scheduled for February 1, 2, 8, and 9, 2026. It may have single or multiple slots based on the number of applicants. The paper comprises 65 questions totaling 100 marks, with 10 questions in General Aptitude and 55 in Engineering Mathematics and Core Discipline.

GATE CSE Syllabus 2026- Important Topics and Sub-Topics

GATE Computer Science and Information Technology (CS) is one of the paper with the highest number of applicants each year.

[GATE Syllabus 2026](#) for Computer Science and Information Technology (CS) consists of topics from-

General Aptitude

Engineering Mathematics

Core Discipline

GATE CSE Weightage of Important Topics (Expected)

Topics	Expected Weightage (Marks)	Expected Weightage (Questions)
General Aptitude	15	10
Engineering Mathematics	13	10
Discrete Mathematics		
Digital Logic	6	3
Computer Organization and Architecture	8	5
Programming and Data Structures	15	8
Algorithms	7	4

Theory of Computation	6	4
Compiler Design	4	3
Operating System	9	6
Databases	7	4
Computer Networks	10	8

GATE CSE- Previous Years' Weightage of Important Topics

Topics	Number of Questions			
-	2024	2023	2022	2021
Algorithms	6	4	6	8
Data Structures and Programming	7	6	6	5
Computer Organization	5	5	5	4
Digital Logic	3	6	3	3
Computer Network	4	5	7	4
Theory of Computation	7	6	6	5
Databases	5	3	5	5
Compiler Design	4	4	3	5
Operating Systems	4	6	4	4
Discrete Mathematics	6	5	6	7
Engineering Mathematics	4	5	4	5
General Aptitude	10	10	10	10

GATE CSE- Previous Years' Marks Weightage of Important Topics

Topics	Year-wise Weightage of Important Topics (Marks)					
	GATE 2021	GATE 2020	GATE 2019	GATE 2018	GATE 2017	GATE 2016
General Aptitude	15	15	15	15	15	15
Engineering Mathematics	6	5	6	7	8	10
Discrete Mathematics	11	10	7	12	7	4
Digital Logic	5	4	9	4	5	5
Computer Organization and Architecture	6	11	3	11	9	7
Programming and Data Structures	8	12	12	10	14	11
Algorithms	12	6	7	7	6	11
Theory of Computation	8	9	7	7	9	9
Compiler Design	8	4	6	6	4	4
Operating System	5	10	10	10	10	10
Databases	8	8	8	4	6	5
Computer Networks	8	6	10	7	7	9

GATE CSE 2026 Most Expected Questions

Subject	Most Expected Topics
Algorithms	Complexity Analysis
	Sorting Algorithms

	Graph Algorithms
Data Structures and Programming	Tree
	Linkedlist
	Recursion
	Pointers
Computer Organization & Arch.	Cache Organisation
	Pipelining
	Addressing modes
	Combinational Circuits
	Minimization
Computer Networks	IP Addressing
	TCP/IP
	Regular Expression
	Undecidability
Databases	SQL
	Relational Algebra
	Indexing
	Normalization
Compiler Design	Parsers

	Run time environments
	Paging
	Page Replacement Algorithms
Discrete Maths	Graph Theory
	Sets Theory
	Mathematical Logic
	Relations
Engineering Mathematics	Conditional probability
	Linear Algebra
	Limits

GATE CSE Exam Pattern

GATE CSE Exam Pattern

GATE CS Exam Mode: Online

GATE CS Duration: 3 hours

Types of Questions: MCQs and NAT

Number of Sections: 3 sections – General Aptitude, Mathematics and Core Discipline (CS)

Total questions: 65 questions

[Check GATE CS Exam Pattern 2026](#)

Sections	Total Questions	Total Marks
General Aptitude	10	15
Engineering Mathematics	55	13
Core Discipline- Computer Science and Information Technology		72
Total	65	100

GATE CSE Marking Scheme

Sections	Total Questions	Total Marks
----------	-----------------	-------------

	1 mark Questions	2 marks Questions	
General Aptitude	5	5	$(5 \times 1) + (5 \times 2) = 15$
Engineering Mathematics	25	30	$(25 \times 1) + (30 \times 2) = 85$
Core Discipline- Mechanical Engineering			
Total	30	35	100

There is no provision of negative marking in NAT and MSQs.

Meanwhile, MCQs do have a negative marking.

1/3 mark is deducted for each incorrect 1 mark MCQ.

2/3 mark is deducted for each incorrect 2 marks MCQs.

Also Check: [What will be the Validity of GATE Score?](#)

GATE CSE Preparation

GATE CSE Preparation 2026

Although the preparation strategy for each candidate will differ depending on their learning and retaining ability, however, the section below covers a few general tips for GATE CSE Preparation.

Start with topics that have a higher weightage and also more number of topics to cover and make sure to prepare/practice daily for this paper.

While preparing, focus on Numerical Questions and Theoretical questions equally.

Devote a good amount of time to maths topics daily, as it guarantees 13-15 marks easily.

The General Aptitude section in GATE CSE paper is also quite important and can prove as a scoring section with 15 marks. Therefore, make sure to cover all the topics and practice as many mock tests as possible.

Gather the best resources for GATE CSE Preparation. These can include YouTube videos, study manuals, best books, telegram groups, etc.

GATE CSE Preparation Quick Study Plan

Time Allotment	Activities to Do
6:00 AM to 9:00 AM	Pen down the important topics and scan all the important points/Prepare your Daily Study Plan

9:00 AM to 11:00 AM	Take a Break
11:00 AM to 2:00 PM	Pick up a Major Topic as you planned in the morning
2:00 PM to 6:00 PM	Take a Break
6:00 PM to 9:00 PM	Go through all the topics that you have covered in the day or you can also continue with the preparation of Major Topic
10:00 PM	A quick go through of the Notes and try to sleep early

GATE CSE Preparation Best Books

Books	Authors/Publisher
GATE Computer Science & Information Technology	GKP, G.K. Pub
TRB Lecturers (Computer Science & Engineering) Exam	A panel of Authors, Sura College of Competition
A Handbook for Computer Science /IT Engineering	Made Easy Editorial Board, Made Easy Publications
Graph Theory with Applications to Engineering and Computer Science	Deo and Narsingh, Prentice Hall India Learning Private Limited
GATE 2020: Computer Science and IT Engineering Solved Papers	ME Team, Made Easy Publications

Question: Based on the previous years papers can you suggest some important topics for GATE computer science?

Ans: Although all topics from GATE CSE Syllabus are important to score good in the exam, some of the topics with the highest weightage include-

- Computer Organization and Architecture
- Programming and Data Structures
- Algorithms
- Operating System
- Computer Networks

Question: I have study notes from my graduation. Will these notes be enough to prepare for GATE CSE?

Ans: It is good that you have notes from your graduation because GATE CSE Syllabus is based on the topics from the graduation level. Other than these notes you can also refer to the following books:

- GATE Computer Science & Information Technology – By GKP, G.K. Pub
- A Handbook for Computer Science /IT Engineering – Made Easy Editorial Board, Made Easy Publications

Question: What will be the section-wise weightage of topics in GATE computer science?

Ans: GATE CSE Syllabus can be divided into three sections-

- General Aptitude with a weightage of 15%.
- Engineering Mathematics with a weightage of 13%.
- Core Discipline (CS) with a weightage of 72%.

Ques. What is the weightage of topics in GATE CSE Syllabus?

Ans. Based on the previous year exam analysis, the table below shows the expected weightage of topics from GATE CSE Syllabus-

Topics	Expected Weightage of Important Topics (Marks)
General Aptitude	15
Engineering Mathematics	13
Discrete Mathematics	
Digital Logic	6
Computer Organization and Architecture	8
Programming and Data Structures	15
Algorithms	7
Theory of Computation	6
Compiler Design	4
Operating System	9
Databases	7
Computer Networks	10

Question: Will there be any negative marking in GATE CSE paper?

Ans: Yes. For each paper in GATE, there is a negative marking for each incorrect MCQ while there is no negative marking for MSQs and NATs. The table below covers the further details on GATE CSE negative marking.

Type of Question	GATE ME Negative Marking	
	1 Mark Questions	2 Marks Questions
Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)	1/3 mark	2/3 mark
Multiple Select Questions (MSQs)	No negative marking	No negative marking
Numerical Answer Type (NATs)	No negative marking	No negative marking